

Sweltering heat grips northern India

IMD issues **advisories** as **vast swathes** of the country **brace for** even hotter days ahead

As April nears its end, large parts of northern and central India are already in the grip of a **blistering** heatwave, with temperatures **soaring** well beyond seasonal norms. **Delhi**, the national capital, **has** touched 42°C — an **ominous marker considering** that the hottest months of May and June still lie ahead.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has **sounded** a yellow alert for the city, warning that maximum temperatures could touch 43°C in the coming days, a full 3–4 degrees above the usual average for this time of year. This **unrelenting** heat has not **spared** other parts of the country either. **States** across north, central, and eastern India — including Rajasthan, Punjab, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha, and West Bengal — **are witnessing** an early and intense summer. In parts of Jharkhand, temperatures have already **breached** the 43°C mark, **prompting** fresh warnings and health advisories from the IMD. The early **arrival** of such extreme heat **is** no longer an **anomaly**, but rather an indication of broader climatic shift.

Meteorologists have **attributed** this current **spell to** a combination of local and global factors. Dry and hot westerly winds continue to **sweep** across the northern plains, preventing any cloud development and keeping the heat trapped at the surface. **A Western Disturbance** — an upper air system that usually brings brief relief in the form of rain and cooler winds — **is** active, but its influence has largely remained **confined** to the Himalayan region, failing to bring much **respite** to the plains.

Additionally, global climate **patterns** such as the **El Niño phenomenon** in the Pacific Ocean **are** likely playing a role in **distorting** India's seasonal cycles. These disruptions are contributing to the growing **unpredictability** of weather, **often resulting in prolonged** dry spells, delayed monsoons, or early heatwaves. While temperatures have been climbing steadily, the IMD has made it clear that the coming days will be particularly challenging. The capital region is under a yellow alert, with authorities advising people to avoid stepping out during peak afternoon hours between 11 AM and 3 PM. **Precautions** such as staying **hydrated**, using umbrellas or hats, and wearing light, breathable clothing **have** been strongly recommended. The **consequences** of such extreme weather **go** far beyond **mere** discomfort. Public health experts warn of increased risks of **heatstroke**, **dehydration**, and respiratory illnesses.

For **vulnerable** populations such as the elderly, children, outdoor laborers, and those with pre-existing conditions, the risk is especially high. There are also growing concerns about the **strain** on infrastructure, particularly in terms of water and electricity. With power demand peaking due to widespread use of fans and air conditioning, there is a very real danger of grid overloads and **outages**.

Water reservoirs, already under stress in several regions, **are** likely to see further **depletion** as **evaporation** rates **surge**. Simultaneously, the **contrast** in regional weather patterns continues to

widen. While the north and central parts of the country **reel** under extreme heat, the northeastern states are bracing for heavy rainfall. The IMD has forecast widespread showers **accompanied** by thunderstorms, lightning, and strong winds — particularly over Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Nagaland, Mizoram, and Tripura.

This **rainfall**, expected between April 25 and 29, **offers** a **stark** reminder of India's increasingly uneven climate patterns — with floods and droughts occurring side by side in different corners of the nation. Further south, **states** such as Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and coastal Andhra Pradesh **are dealing with** a different but equally **taxing** weather pattern — hot and humid conditions that pose their own set of challenges, particularly for urban populations. This spell of early heat serves as yet another warning about the growing impact of climate change.

Once considered rare, heatwaves are now more frequent, more intense, and longer-lasting. Their **consequences** — on health, **livelihoods**, agriculture, and infrastructure — **are** already being felt and will likely worsen in the absence of strong **mitigation** and **adaptation** measures.

As India **heads** into what could be one of its hottest summers on record, it is clear that the **time** for reactive measures **is** over. Urban planning must prioritise **heat-resilient** infrastructure, public awareness campaigns must be **ramped up**, and long-term policies **addressing** climate adaptation need urgent attention.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Sweltering** (adjective) – scorching, blazing, searing, burning, torrid झुलसाने वाला
2. **Advisory** (noun) – warning, bulletin, alert, notification, message चेतावनी
3. **Vast** (adjective) – immense, extensive, massive, enormous, boundless विशाल
4. **Swathe** (noun) – stretch, expanse, belt, strip, zone क्षेत्र
5. **Brace** (for) (verb) – prepare, get ready, steel oneself, gear up, fortify तैयार होना
6. **Blistering** (adjective) – extremely hot, intense, fiery, scorching, sweltering अत्यधिक गर्म
7. **Soar** (verb) – rise, climb, escalate, increase, surge तेजी से बढ़ना
8. **Ominous** (adjective) – threatening, foreboding, grim, alarming, menacing अशुभ
9. **Marker** (noun) – indicator, sign, signal, pointer, milestone संकेत
10. **Considering** (preposition) – in view of, taking into account, given, bearing in mind, keeping in mind को ध्यान में रखते हुए
11. **Sound** (verb) – issue, declare, announce, signal, alert आभास देना
12. **Unrelenting** (adjective) – relentless, persistent, unyielding, merciless, nonstop न रुके वाला
13. **Spare** (verb) – leave unharmed, exempt, avoid, bypass, escape नहीं बखशना / छोड़ना
14. **Witness** (verb) – experience, observe, undergo, see, encounter देखना
15. **Breach** (verb) – exceed, break, surpass, go beyond, violate तोड़ना
16. **Mark** (noun) – level, point, target, threshold, indicator स्तर
17. **Prompt** (verb) – trigger, provoke, cause, initiate, lead to प्रेरित करना
18. **Anomaly** (noun) – irregularity, deviation, abnormality, oddity, exception असंगति
19. **Attribute** (to) (verb) – ascribe, credit, assign, link, connect कारण मानना
20. **Spell** (noun) – period, stretch, phase, stint, run अवधि
21. **Sweep** (verb) – blow, gust, move swiftly, flow, rush फैलना
22. **Confine** (to) (verb) – restrict, limit, restrain, enclose, bound सीमित रहना
23. **Respite** (noun) – relief, break, pause, rest, interval राहत

24. **El Niño** (noun) – a climate pattern that describes the unusual warming of surface waters in the eastern tropical Pacific Ocean.
25. **Phenomenon** (noun) – event, occurrence, incident, happening, development घटना
26. **Distort** (verb) – twist, alter, misrepresent, deform, warp विकृत करना
27. **Unpredictability** (noun) – uncertainty, instability, variability, inconsistency, fluctuation अनिश्चितता
28. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, commonly, usually, repeatedly अक्सर
29. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – lead to, cause, bring about, produce, end in परिणाम होना
30. **Prolonged** (adjective) – extended, lengthy, drawn-out, protracted, continuous लम्बे समय तक चलने वाला
31. **Hydrated** (adjective) – moisturized, replenished, water-filled, quenched, well-supplied जलयुक्त
32. **Heatstroke** (noun) – sunstroke, overheating, heat illness, thermal shock, hyperthermia लू लगना
33. **Dehydration** (noun) – drying out, lack of fluids, desiccation, water loss, thirst निर्जलीकरण
34. **Vulnerable** (adjective) – at risk, exposed, susceptible, defenseless, weak असुरक्षित
35. **Strain** (noun) – stress, pressure, tension, burden, overload दबाव
36. **Outage** (noun) – power cut, blackout, shutdown, failure, disruption कटौती का समय
37. **Depletion** (noun) – exhaustion, reduction, decline, diminishing, drain कमी / क्षय
38. **Evaporation** (noun) – vaporization, drying up, dissipation, disappearance, sublimation वाष्पीकरण
39. **Surge** (verb) – increase, rise, escalate, grow, climb तेज़ी से बढ़ना
40. **Contrast** (noun) – difference, disparity, distinction, variation, comparison विरोध / अंतर
41. **Reel** (verb) – struggle, stagger, falter, suffer, wobble झेलना
42. **Accompany** (verb) – go with, come with, attend, escort, follow के साथ होना
43. **Stark** (adjective) – clear, obvious, harsh, severe, absolute स्पष्ट
44. **Deal (with)** (verb) – handle, manage, tackle, cope with, address निपटना
45. **Taxing** (adjective) – exhausting, demanding, burdensome, difficult, strenuous थकाने वाला / कठिन

46. **Livelihood** (noun) – means of living, income, employment, sustenance, work
आजीविका

47. **Mitigation** (noun) – reduction, alleviation, lessening, easing, moderation न्यूनीकरण

48. **Adaptation measure** (noun) – actions taken to reduce the negative impacts of climate change and increase resilience to current and future climate conditions अनुकूलन
उपाय

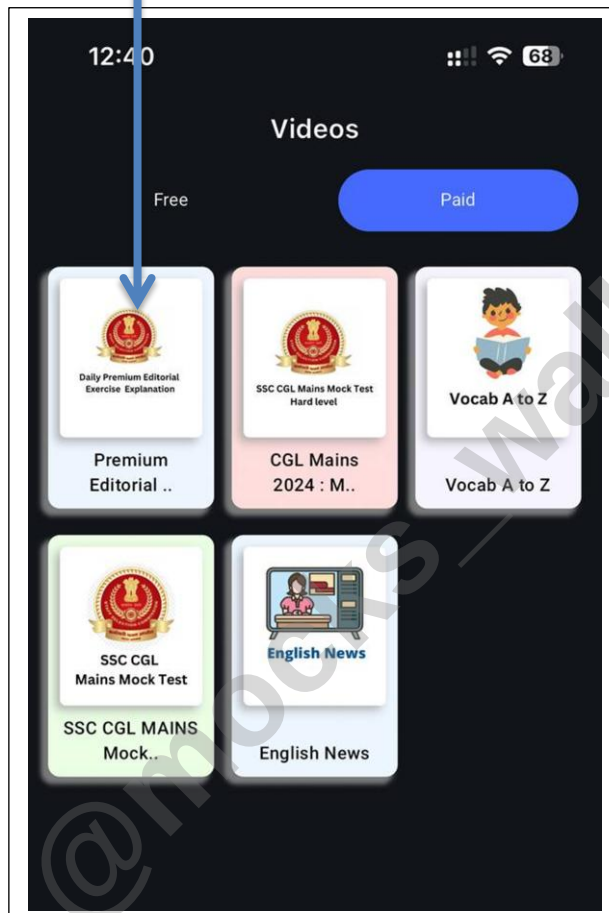
49. **Head** (verb) – move toward, proceed, go, approach, travel अग्रसर होना

50. **Heat-resilient** (adjective) – heat-tolerant, climate-proof, thermally resistant, adaptive, robust – गर्मी सहनशील

51. **Ramp up** (phrasal verb) – increase, boost, escalate, step up, intensify बढ़ाना

52. **Address** (verb) – tackle, resolve, deal with, attend to, confront समाधान करना

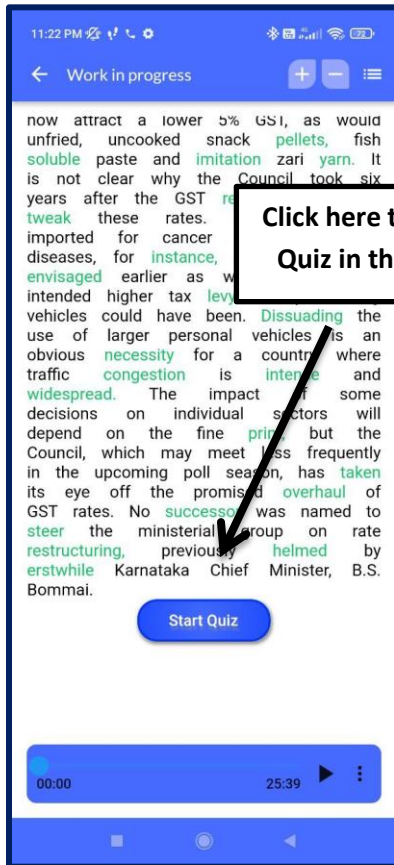
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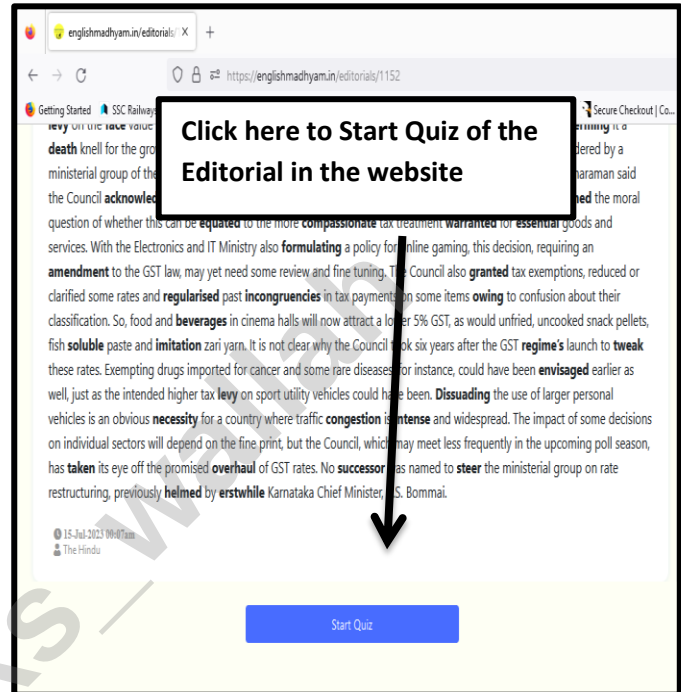
Summary of the Editorial

1. Northern and central India are experiencing a severe heatwave, with temperatures already exceeding seasonal norms in April.
2. Delhi has recorded temperatures as high as 42°C, with forecasts predicting it may reach 43°C soon.
3. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has issued a **yellow alert** for Delhi and other affected regions.
4. States like Rajasthan, Punjab, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha, and West Bengal are facing unusually intense and early summer heat.
5. Some areas in Jharkhand have already crossed the 43°C mark, prompting health warnings from the IMD.
6. The early onset of such extreme heat is seen as a symptom of a broader **climatic shift**, not a one-time anomaly.
7. Meteorologists cite hot, dry westerly winds and limited cloud formation as key contributors to the current heatwave.
8. A Western Disturbance has had little effect on cooling the northern plains, with its impact mostly limited to the Himalayan region.
9. **Global climate phenomena**, particularly El Niño, are disrupting India's seasonal weather patterns.
10. The IMD has advised citizens, especially in urban areas, to avoid going out between 11 AM and 3 PM and to take preventive health measures.
11. Health risks include **heatstroke, dehydration, and respiratory problems**, especially among the elderly, children, and outdoor workers.
12. The heatwave is putting serious stress on **power and water infrastructure**, increasing the risk of electricity blackouts and water shortages.
13. While north and central India face extreme heat, northeastern states are expected to receive **heavy rainfall** with thunderstorms and strong winds.
14. Southern states like Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and coastal Andhra Pradesh are experiencing **hot and humid** weather conditions.
15. The editorial underscores the need for long-term **climate adaptation policies**, including heat-resilient urban planning and public awareness measures, as heatwaves become more frequent and dangerous.

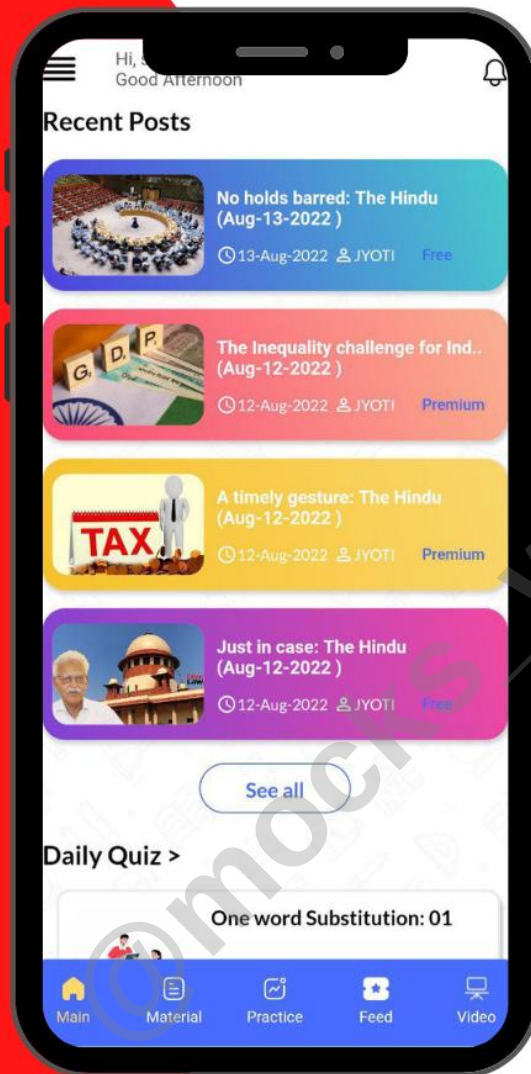
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